

ELIAS THORNE

Principal Cloud Architect & Digital Transformation Lead Location: Denver, Colorado **Email:** elias.thorne.architect@nexus-mail.com **Phone:** (720) 555-0198 **LinkedIn:** <https://www.google.com/search?q=linkedin.com/in/eliasthorne-cloud-strat>

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Distinguished Principal Cloud Architect with over 12 years of specialized experience in orchestrating large-scale digital transformations, hybrid-cloud migrations, and enterprise-grade infrastructure optimization. Proven track record of guiding Fortune 500 financial and technology firms through complex modernization initiatives, managing budgets exceeding \$15M annually, and leading cross-functional teams of 30+ engineers.

Expert in bridging the gap between high-level business strategy and granular technical execution. Renowned for designing self-healing, highly available distributed systems that reduce operational overhead while maximizing security posture. Deeply experienced in regulatory compliance (SOC2, PCI-DSS, HIPAA) within highly regulated industries. A champion of DevOps culture, automation, and "Infrastructure as Code" (IaC), consistently delivering double-digit efficiency gains and multi-million dollar cost reductions through architectural excellence.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Strategic Planning:** Enterprise Cloud Strategy, Digital Transformation Roadmaps, Disaster Recovery & Business Continuity (DRBC), Vendor Rationalization, Capital Expenditure (CAPEX) vs. Operational Expenditure (OPEX) Modeling.
- **Architecture & Design:** Microservices Architecture, Serverless Computing, Event-Driven Architecture, Multi-Cloud & Hybrid-Cloud Design, Zero Trust Security Frameworks.
- **Operational Excellence:** Site Reliability Engineering (SRE), Root Cause Analysis (RCA), SLA/SLO Management, Capacity Planning, Performance Tuning.
- **Leadership:** Technical Mentorship, Agile/Scrum Leadership, Stakeholder Management, C-Level Presentations, Cross-functional Team Building.
- **Compliance & Governance:** Cloud Center of Excellence (CCoE) Establishment, Policy as Code, GDPR/CCPA Compliance, Identity & Access Management (IAM).

TECHNICAL SKILLS INVENTORY

- **Cloud Platforms:** AWS (EC2, Lambda, S3, RDS, EKS, VPC, Route53), Microsoft Azure (AKS, CosmosDB, Azure Functions, VNet), Google Cloud Platform (GKE, BigQuery, Pub/Sub).
- **Containerization & Orchestration:** Docker, Kubernetes (K8s), Helm, Istio Service Mesh, OpenShift, Rancher.
- **Infrastructure as Code (IaC):** Terraform, AWS CloudFormation, Azure Resource Manager (ARM), Ansible, Packer, Pulumi.
- **CI/CD & DevOps:** Jenkins, GitLab CI, GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps, CircleCI, ArgoCD, Spinnaker.

- **Databases & Storage:** PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Cassandra, DynamoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch, Snowflake.
- **Monitoring & Observability:** Prometheus, Grafana, Datadog, New Relic, ELK Stack (Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana), Splunk.
- **Scripting & Languages:** Python, Go (Golang), Bash/Shell, PowerShell, Node.js, Java.
- **Security Tools:** HashiCorp Vault, SonarQube, Aqua Security, Palo Alto Prisma Cloud, AWS Shield.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

APEX ZENITH FINANCIAL | Denver, CO

Principal Cloud Architect (Director Level) *January 2021 – Present*

Lead architect for a global financial services firm, overseeing the cloud center of excellence and the migration of mission-critical banking applications from on-premise mainframes to a hybrid AWS/Azure environment.

Key Responsibilities & Achievements:

- **Enterprise Cloud Migration:** Spearheaded the "Project Stratosphere" initiative, migrating 450+ monolithic applications to a microservices-based architecture on AWS EKS.
 - *Result:* Reduced annual infrastructure licensing costs by **42% (\$3.2M savings)** and improved application deployment frequency from monthly to daily.
- **Availability & Resilience:** Architected a multi-region Active-Active disaster recovery solution spanning AWS US-East and US-West regions.
 - *Result:* Achieved **99.999% uptime** for core transaction processing systems, handling peak loads of 15,000 transactions per second (TPS).
- **FinOps & Cost Optimization:** Established a FinOps governing body and implemented automated cost-control policies using Terraform Sentinel and AWS Budgets.
 - *Result:* Identified and eliminated **\$850,000** in annualized waste (orphaned snapshots, over-provisioned instances) within the first 6 months.
- **Security Governance:** Led the implementation of a Zero Trust network architecture using Istio Service Mesh and OPA (Open Policy Agent) for 35 engineering squads.
 - *Result:* Passed SOC2 Type II and PCI-DSS audits with **zero critical non-conformities** for three consecutive years.
- **Team Leadership:** Directly managed a team of 12 Senior Architects and functionally led a broader organization of 50+ DevOps engineers. Conducted performance reviews, established career ladders, and increased team retention by 25%.

NEBULA SYSTEMS INTEGRATORS | Chicago, IL

Senior Solutions Architect *June 2018 – December 2020*

Served as a lead technical consultant for Fortune 500 clients in retail and logistics, designing bespoke cloud-native solutions and guiding modernization efforts.

Key Responsibilities & Achievements:

- **Client: Global Logistics Giant:** Designed an IoT data ingestion platform on Azure using Event Hubs and Stream Analytics to track 50,000+ shipping containers in real-time.

- *Result:* Reduced supply chain latency by **60%**, enabling the client to offer premium "instant-track" services that generated **\$8M in new revenue**.
- **Client: National Retail Chain:** Re-platformed a legacy e-commerce site to a serverless architecture using AWS Lambda and API Gateway prior to Black Friday.
 - *Result:* Successfully handled a **400% traffic spike** (2M concurrent users) with zero downtime, while reducing compute costs by **70%** compared to the previous EC2-based solution.
- **DevOps Transformation:** Introduced GitOps methodologies using ArgoCD and Kubernetes to a client's development organization comprising 200+ developers.
 - *Result:* Reduced Mean Time to Recovery (MTTR) from 4 hours to **15 minutes** and increased deployment velocity by **300%**.
- **Sales Engineering:** Partnered with the sales team to draft technical proposals and Statements of Work (SOWs) for complex enterprise deals.
 - *Result:* Instrumental in closing **\$12M** in consulting contracts over two years.

VECTOR STREAM CORP | Austin, TX

DevOps Tech Lead *March 2016 – May 2018*

Led the transition from manual infrastructure management to full automation for a high-growth SaaS platform provider.

Key Responsibilities & Achievements:

- **Infrastructure Automation:** Built the company's first fully automated infrastructure provisioning pipeline using Terraform and Ansible.
 - *Result:* Reduced server provisioning time from 3 days to **45 minutes**, eliminating human error and configuration drift.
- **Container Adoption:** Led the "Container First" strategy, dockerizing 40+ Java and Python applications and orchestrating them via an early adoption of Kubernetes (v1.6).
 - *Result:* Improved resource utilization efficiency by **50%**, delaying the need for a data center expansion for 18 months.
- **Monitoring Overhaul:** Replaced a fragmented monitoring landscape (Nagios/Cacti) with a unified ELK Stack and Prometheus solution.
 - *Result:* Reduced false-positive alerts by **85%**, allowing the operations team to focus on genuine performance incidents.
- **Database Scaling:** Managed the sharding and replication strategy for a multi-terabyte MongoDB cluster supporting high-velocity user data.
 - *Result:* Decreased query latency by **200ms** at the 99th percentile (p99).

IRONCLAD NETWORKS | Austin, TX

Systems Engineer *June 2014 – February 2016*

Managed on-premise Linux infrastructure and virtualization for a regional telecommunications provider.

Key Responsibilities & Achievements:

- **Virtualization:** Executed the P2V (Physical to Virtual) migration of 500+ RHEL servers into a VMware vSphere environment.
 - *Result:* Reduced data center footprint by **40 racks**, significantly lowering power and cooling costs.

- **Automation Scripting:** Developed comprehensive Python and Bash scripts to automate routine system patching, user provisioning, and log rotation.
 - *Result:* Saved approximately **20 engineering hours per week**, repurposing that time for strategic upgrades.
- **Storage Management:** Administered a NetApp SAN environment, implementing data deduplication and snapshot retention policies.
 - *Result:* Reclaimed **40TB** of storage capacity, deferring hardware purchases by 12 months.

KEY PROJECTS & CASE STUDIES

Project: "Titan" – Mainframe Offloading Engine

- **Client/Employer:** Apex Zenith Financial
- **Role:** Chief Architect
- **Budget:** \$5.5M
- **Description:** Designed a solution to offload read-heavy traffic from a legacy IBM Mainframe to a cloud-native caching layer.
- **Architecture:** Utilized AWS DMS (Database Migration Service) to replicate DB2 data to Amazon Aurora PostgreSQL. Implemented a Redis write-through cache for API consumption.
- **Outcome:** Reduced mainframe MIPS (Million Instructions Per Second) usage by **35%**, saving the company **\$2.1M annually** in IBM licensing fees.

Project: "Nebula" – Multi-Cloud Kubernetes Federation

- **Client/Employer:** Nebula Systems Integrators (Confidential Pharmaceutical Client)
- **Role:** Lead Architect
- **Budget:** \$3M
- **Description:** Created a unified container platform spanning AWS, Azure, and on-premise data centers to support drug discovery computation.
- **Architecture:** Deployed Red Hat OpenShift across three environments. Implemented a centralized image registry with Aqua Security scanning to ensure no vulnerabilities were introduced into the research pipeline.
- **Outcome:** Allowed researchers to burst compute workloads to the public cloud during peak analysis times, accelerating drug trial simulations by **4x**.

Project: "Shield" – Automated Compliance Framework

- **Client/Employer:** Apex Zenith Financial
- **Role:** Technical Lead
- **Description:** Automated the enforcement of regulatory controls across 150+ AWS accounts.
- **Architecture:** Developed a library of 80+ custom AWS Config rules and Lambda auto-remediation functions. Integrated with ServiceNow for audit trail generation.
- **Outcome:** Reduced manual audit preparation time from 6 weeks to **3 days** per quarter.

LEADERSHIP & TEAM MANAGEMENT EXPERIENCE

- **Cloud Center of Excellence (CCoE) Chair:** Founded and currently chair the CCoE at Apex Zenith, a governing body of 12 senior technologists responsible for setting cloud standards, approving architectural patterns, and managing vendor relationships.
- **Mentorship Program:** Established a formal mentorship program pairing Senior Architects with Junior DevOps Engineers. Successfully graduated 15 engineers to Senior levels over 3 years.
- **Hiring & Recruitment:** Redesigned the technical interview process to focus on practical, scenario-based assessments rather than whiteboard coding. Reduced "bad hire" rate to near zero and decreased time-to-hire by 20%.
- **Agile Transformation:** Transitioned infrastructure teams from Waterfall to Kanban/Scrum methodologies. Acts as Release Train Engineer (RTE) for large-scale quarterly planning events (PI Planning).

PROCESS IMPROVEMENTS & AUTOMATION ACHIEVEMENTS

- **"One-Click" Environment Provisioning:** Created a self-service internal developer platform (IDP) using Backstage.io. Developers can now spin up ephemeral test environments in 10 minutes without filing IT tickets.
 - *Impact:* Increased developer productivity by approximately **15%**.
- **Automated Disaster Recovery Testing:** Replaced annual, manual DR drills with continuous chaos engineering experiments using Gremlin.
 - *Impact:* Uncovered and fixed 12 critical failover vulnerabilities that manual testing missed.
- **Secret Management Overhaul:** Eliminated hardcoded credentials across 200+ repositories by implementing HashiCorp Vault with dynamic secret injection.
 - *Impact:* Eliminated security incidents related to credential leakage.

CERTIFICATIONS

- **AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional (SAP-C01)** | Valid through 2026
- **Microsoft Certified: Azure Solutions Architect Expert** | Valid through 2025
- **Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)** | The Linux Foundation
- **Certified Kubernetes Security Specialist (CKS)** | The Linux Foundation
- **HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate**
- **CISSP – Certified Information Systems Security Professional (Associate)**

EDUCATION

Master of Business Administration (MBA) *Emphasis in Technology Management* University of Colorado Boulder – Leeds School of Business *Graduated: 2019*

Bachelor of Science in Computer Engineering University of Texas at Austin *Graduated: 2014*
Graduated Cum Laude

TOOLS & TECHNOLOGIES

- **Cloud:** AWS, Azure, GCP, VMware vSphere, OpenStack
- **Operating Systems:** RHEL/CentOS, Ubuntu, Debian, Windows Server 2016/2019/2022

- **Networking:** VPC Design, VPN, Direct Connect, ExpressRoute, BGP, DNS, Load Balancing (ALB/NLB/F5)
- **Web Servers:** Nginx, Apache, IIS, Tomcat
- **Version Control:** Git, Subversion (Legacy knowledge)
- **Project Management:** Jira, Confluence, Trello, Asana, Microsoft Project

PUBLICATIONS & CONFERENCES

- **Speaker, KubeCon North America 2023:** *Session: "Scaling Stateful Sets: Lessons from Fintech."*
- **Panelist, Denver Cloud Summit 2022:** *Topic: "The Reality of Hybrid Cloud Economics."*
- **Article:** *"Why Your Lift-and-Shift Strategy Will Fail: A Guide to Modernization"* – Published on CloudComputingInsider.com (2021).
- **Whitepaper:** *"Zero Trust in a Legacy World"* – Internal publication for Nebula Systems, distributed to 50+ enterprise clients.